

Oriental Institute

D26



[If you have comments, send additional information](#)

Address: 1155 East 58th Street
Year Construction: 1931
Year Acquired: 1931
Architect: Mayers Murray and Phillip
Gross Square Feet: 103,013
Primary Use: Academic Office
Design Zone: Main Quadrangle
Last Major Renovation: 1998
Comments:

Last Major Renovation 1998 building addition and reconfigured exhibition galleries designed by Hammond Beeby & Babka

REGULATORY STATUS

National Register: No
NR Historic District:
 Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District
Chicago HRS Color Code: Orange

1 - Site

Land Ownership Status: Owned
Location - Physical:

No comment

Location - Program Adjacency:

Program is substantially contained within building complex.

Location Comment:

Adjacent to and planned in conjunction with Rockefeller Chapel.

2 - Adaptability

Construction Type:

Reinforced concrete construction

Accessibility:

Entrance - Y; Bathrooms - P

Floor-to-Floor Height:

LL: 11'-0"; 1st Floor: 18'-0"; 2nd Floor: 15'-0"; 3rd Floor: 10'-0"

Structural Capability:

Structural analysis would be required - structural drawings are available.

Adaptability Exterior:

Previous library addition to the south of the building was executed with detailing similar to original.

Adaptability Interior:

Reconfiguration possible primarily in support and storage areas. Care should be taken when modifying character defining public spaces.

Adaptability Physical Features:

No comment

Adaptability Structure:

Steel and reinforced concrete construction would allow for reconfiguration.

3 - Building Envelope

Roof Type: Clay Tile (2001)

Exterior Facade:

Stone

Exterior Base: Limestone

Exterior Trim: Limestone

4 - Heritage and Historic

Landmark Status:

no

National Register: No

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

NR Comments:

Not Listed on district nomination form

CHRS Comments:

Possesses potentially significant architectural or historical significance

Heritage - Exterior:

Substantially intact exterior with original windows and entry door. Carved stone tympanum over main entrance designed with assistance of J. H. Breasted. Interior court features landscape design by Beatrix Farrand.

Heritage - Interior:

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Several important interior spaces remain in the museum galleries, auditorium, reading room, lobby and stairways with original decorative elements such as carved stone ornament, decorative metalwork and light fixtures, stone and tile flooring, decorative plasterwork at ceilings and coves, decorative paint schemes, decorative carved wood ceiling beams, and commemorative plaques.

Significant Spaces Identified:

No Comment

Heritage Culture Elements:

Initial museum collection originally housed in Haskell Hall. Research activities include the Epigraphic Survey housed at Chicago House in Luxor, Egypt.

Architectural Awards Certification:

None identified

Heritage and History - General Comments:

The Oriental Institute was founded in 1919 by John D. Rockefeller who also provided funds in 1931 to construct the building. James Henry Breasted was appointed by President Harper as first teaching appointment in Egyptian studies in the US. Building was designed by successor firm to Bertram G. Goodhue, architect of Rockefeller Chapel.

5 - Sustainability

Certifications:

none identified

Window Last Replacement:

Weather Stripping:

R Value Roof/Wall:

Systems:

Deficiencies: